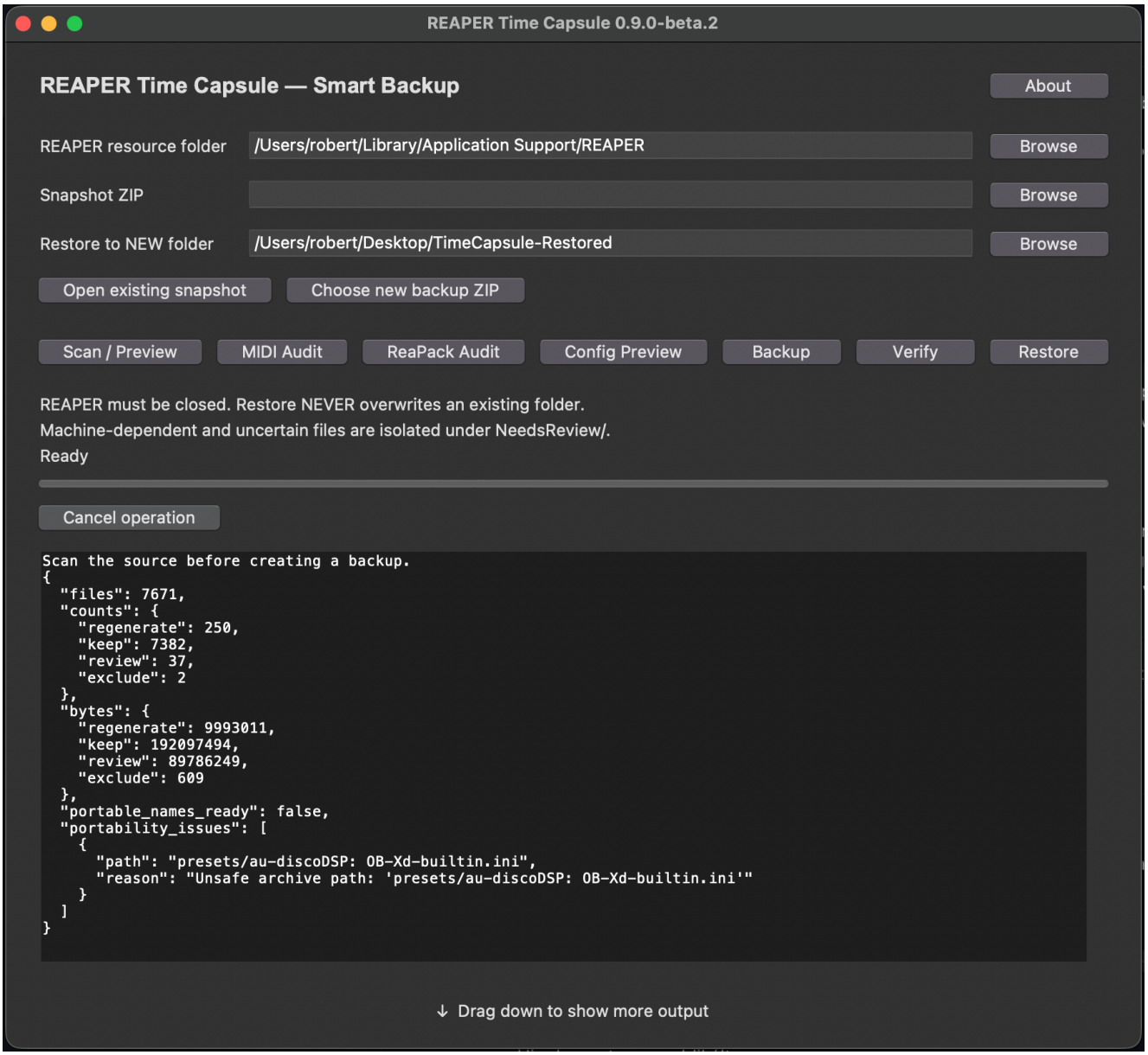
REAPER Time Capsule

Illustrated user guide • macOS & Windows

For the 0.9.0-beta.2 interface • English edition

Preserve your REAPER setup. Restore with confidence.

This guide walks through downloading the unsigned beta, its first-open security prompts, the main window, a normal backup, verification and recovery into a new folder. Labels can change in later builds; use the safety notes shown in your installed version.



Interface image supplied for the project documentation. Paths shown are examples.

1. Download and prepare

01 Download the macOS or Windows archive from the project's GitHub Releases page. Keep the downloaded archive in a private folder.

02 If a SHA256SUMS.txt file is included, compare the downloaded archive's SHA-256 value with the matching line. A matching checksum detects transfer damage; by itself it does not prove who published the file.

03 Extract the archive, then launch **REAPER Time Capsule**. The beta is unsigned and is not notarized by Apple. Windows may also show SmartScreen because there is no publisher signature. Continue only when you trust the project page and the file you downloaded.

2. First launch on macOS

01 Open the downloaded app once. If macOS says it cannot be opened, choose **Done**.

02 Open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**. In the Security area, review the blocked REAPER Time Capsule entry and choose **Open Anyway**.

03 Confirm **Open Anyway** in the next warning. Read the app name carefully before confirming.

04 If macOS asks for an administrator name and password, enter them in the macOS prompt. The app itself never asks for your password. Never share or include the password in a screenshot.

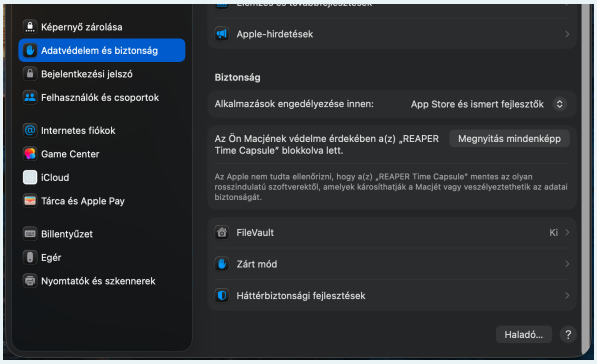
05 Return to the app and open it. These prompts are macOS controls; they do not mean the app is signed or notarized.

macOS security dialog examples

These are the prompts described on the previous page. Only enter administrator credentials into the macOS system dialog.



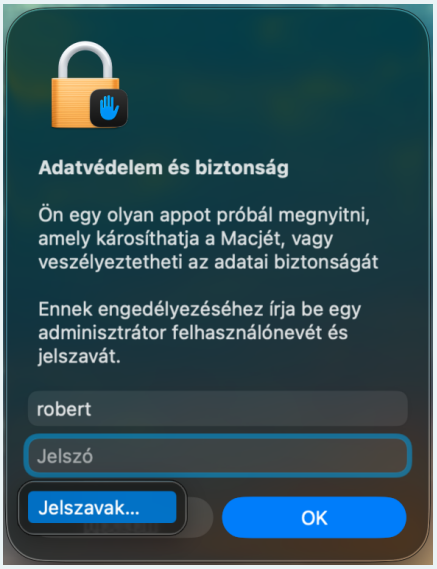
1. First open warning



2. Privacy & Security setting



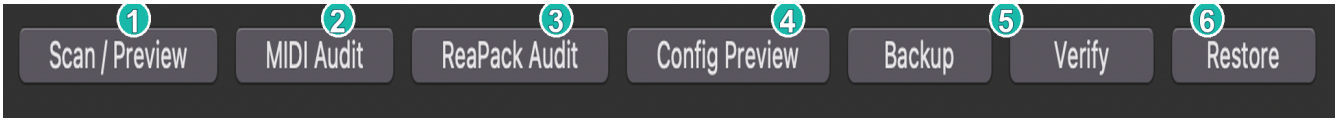
3. Confirm Open Anyway



4. macOS administrator prompt

3. Main window at a glance

The main screen shown in the published beta screenshot. The numbered crop below identifies the seven primary actions.



01 Scan / Preview - read the selected resource folder and summarize file policies and portability issues.

02 MIDI Audit - inspect saved MIDI menus, custom actions and script references. This is a static check, not a live REAPER test.

03 ReaPack Audit - read saved repository settings and the package registry when available. It does not download or install packages.

04 Config Preview - compare two explicitly selected reaper.ini files. This is read-only; unknown settings remain for review.

05 Backup - create and verify a new ZIP capsule. Existing destination files are never overwritten.

06 Verify - check a selected capsule's manifest, safety rules and file checksums.

07 Restore - recover into a new folder. Review isolated files before copying anything into REAPER.

Other controls and status

The three path rows select the REAPER resource folder, the snapshot ZIP, and a **new** restore folder. "Open existing snapshot" selects a ZIP for Verify or Restore; "Choose new backup ZIP" sets the backup destination. The status and progress area show what is running. Cancel asks the current operation to stop safely. The large output pane displays scan or audit reports; scroll vertically and horizontally when needed.

4. Create a backup capsule

01 Close REAPER before starting, so settings and databases are not changing during the scan.

02 In **REAPER resource folder**, choose the resource folder for the REAPER profile you intend to protect. If unsure, use REAPER's resource-path command to locate it. Do not choose your projects folder.

03 Select **Choose new backup ZIP** and choose a new destination name in a private location with enough free space. The application will not replace an existing file.

04 Run **Scan / Preview**. Review totals, excluded links and portability issues. A Windows-incompatible filename can block the portable backup; the scan identifies the path. Keep the original file untouched.

05 Choose **Backup** and wait for completion. Keep the capsule private: it can contain scripts, presets, settings and personal filenames.

Before you start

Keep the original resource folder unchanged. The capsule is a migration aid, not a replacement for a second independent backup.

5. Verify a saved capsule

01 Choose **Open existing snapshot** and select the ZIP you want to check.

02 Press **Verify**. Wait for checksum and policy validation to finish. Do not interrupt the process by closing the app.

03 A successful verification means the archive contents match their manifest checksums and current restore policy. It does not authenticate the publisher, prove a backup is complete for every third-party plugin, or test REAPER runtime behavior.

04 Keep at least one additional copy of an important verified capsule on separate storage.

6. Recover into a new folder

01 Close REAPER. Choose **Open existing snapshot** and select the verified capsule.

02 Set **Restore to NEW folder** to a path that does not exist yet. Restore never merges into or overwrites an existing folder.

03 Press **Restore** and wait for the completed result. The destination contains a **REAPER** folder for portable settings and a **NeedsReview** folder for uncertain or machine-dependent files.

04 Read **RESTORE_REPORT.json**. Compare the staged contents with your current setup. Native extensions, machine-specific settings and unknown resources require manual review. Do not copy the entire NeedsReview folder into an active profile.

05 After review, make a separate backup of the target profile. Copy only selected portable files into a clean, closed REAPER resource folder, resolve conflicts manually, then launch REAPER and check audio/MIDI devices, plugins, menus and scripts.

7. Configuration preview and safe habits

Config Preview compares explicitly selected files and never changes them. Only a small, documented set of appearance values can appear as candidates; versions are supplied by the user and are not independently verified. Unknown keys, hardware, device, plugin-cache and path settings are excluded or marked for review. A preview is not an apply operation.

Safe checklist

• Keep capsules and detailed reports private.

• Use a new restore destination and review before copying.

• Keep REAPER closed for backup and restore.

• Do not share license files, passwords or complete configuration archives in public issues.

• A successful audit does not replace testing in REAPER.

What this beta does not promise

The beta is unsigned. It does not make a complete disk image, install third-party plugins, guarantee every plugin license or preset is portable, or automatically repair action IDs and absolute paths. Hashes detect content changes relative to the manifest; they are not a digital signature. ReaPack data is evidence for review, not permission to install packages automatically.

Help and project

Use the project README and release notes on GitHub for the version you downloaded. When reporting a problem, include the app version, operating system and a short description. Remove personal paths, usernames, tokens, license details and private configuration data from logs or screenshots.

Project documentation • GPL-3.0-only • Independent project, not affiliated with Cockos or REAPER.